Theme 3 title 5 New Believer

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THE ANCIENT PROMISE
How the Old Testament Prophets Predicted Your New Life
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Why This Book Exists

When you first start following Jesus, you get a new life. You get a fresh start. You get a clean slate. You get a new heart. You get a new identity. You get a new family. You get a new future. It is exciting. It is freeing. It is wonderful.

But then you open the Old Testament. You read about prophets and kings and priests. You read about predictions and promises. You read about a coming figure called the Messiah. You might wonder, "What does this have to do with my new life? How does this connect to me?"

I get it. I have been there. I have wondered how the Old Testament connects to my new life. I have wondered why there are so many prophecies. I have wondered who the prophets were talking about. But here is the thing. The Old Testament is not just a history book. It is a promise book. It is a book of predictions about your new life. It is a book of hope for your future. And every prediction points to one person. That person is Jesus.

This book is for you. You are new to the faith. You are building your foundation. Over the next 30 days, we are going to look at 30 ancient promises. We are going to see what they said. We are going to see how Jesus fulfilled them. And we are going to see how they predicted your new life.

The Value You Will Get

By the end of this book, you will not be confused by the Old Testament. You will see it as a promise. You will see it as a preview. You will see it as a preparation. You will understand the ancient promises. You will understand why they are so specific. You will understand why they matter. You will have a new confidence in your faith. You will have a new love for your Bible. And you will have a new appreciation for the new life you have in Christ.

How to Use This Guide

This is a 30 day journey. Each day takes about 5 to 10 minutes. Read the promise. Read the proof. Read why it matters for your new life. Read the faith builder. Read the prayer. If you

are not sure how to pray, just read the words out loud. God hears honest words. He is not looking for fancy language. He is looking for your heart.

Day 01: The Promise of a New Beginning

The Promise (OT)
"And I will put enmity between you and the woman, and between your offspring and hers; he will crush your head, and you will strike his heel." - Genesis 3:15 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

Right after humanity messed up in the garden, God made a promise. He said a descendant of a woman would come. That descendant would crush the serpent's head. It sounds like a riddle. But it is a promise. It is a promise of a hero. It is a promise of a rescue. It is a promise of a new beginning. It is a promise of your new life.

The Proof (NT)
"But when the set time had fully come, God sent his Son, born of a woman, born under the law..." - Galatians 4:4

Jesus is that descendant. He was born of a woman. He came to crush the serpent's head. He came to defeat the devil. On the cross, it looked like the serpent won. But three days later, He rose from the dead. The serpent's head was crushed. The promise was kept. Your new life began.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You are starting a new life. You might feel like the enemy is still winning. You might feel like the battle is still lost. But the promise was kept. The hero has come. He crushed the serpent's head. Your new life is built on His victory. You can trust the ancient promise.

Faith Builder
What part of your old life do you need to leave behind? Write it down. Give it to Jesus. He is your new beginning.

The Prayer
Father, thank you for the promise of a new beginning. Thank you that Jesus came to crush the serpent's head. Thank you that He won the victory. Help me to live in that victory today. Help me to live in my new life. Amen.

Day 02: The Promise of a Blessing

The Promise (OT)
"I will bless those who bless you, and whoever curses you I will curse; and all peoples on earth will be blessed through you." - Genesis 12:3 (Written around 2000 B.C.)

God spoke to Abraham. He told him to leave his home. He gave him a promise. He said, "I will bless you. I will make your name great. You will be a blessing. All peoples on earth will be blessed through you." This was a huge promise. It meant that one day, someone from Abraham's family would change the world. It was a promise of your new life.

The Proof (NT)
"This is the genealogy of Jesus the Messiah the son of David, the son of Abraham..." - Matthew 1:1

The Gospel of Matthew opens with a family tree. It traces the line of Jesus back to Abraham. It shows that Jesus is a descendant of Abraham. He is the one who brings blessing to the whole world. Through Jesus, people from every nation can be forgiven. The promise was kept. Your new life is blessed.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are included in this promise. You are part of the "all peoples." God's blessing is not just for a select group. It is not just for people who were born in the right country or go to the right church. It is for you. You are blessed through Jesus. Your new life is a blessed life.

Faith Builder
Think about your family tree. Think about your background. God can use anyone. He used a wandering nomad to bless the world. He can use you too.

The Prayer
God, thank you for keeping your promises. Thank you that your plan has always been bigger than one person or one nation. Thank you that Jesus came to bless the whole world, including me. Help me to see that I am part of your story. Help me to share the blessing with others. Amen.

Day 03: The Promise of a King

The Promise (OT)
"The scepter will not depart from Judah, nor the ruler's staff from between his feet, until he to whom it belongs shall come and the obedience of the nations shall be his." - Genesis 49:10 (Written around 1800 B.C.)

Jacob was dying. He gathered his twelve sons around his bed. He gave each son a blessing. When he got to Judah, he said something strange. He said the scepter would not depart from Judah. A scepter is a stick a king holds. It is a sign of authority. Jacob was saying that the line of kings would come from Judah. He was saying that one day, the ultimate King would come. This was a promise of your new life.

The Proof (NT)
"For it is clear that our Lord descended from Judah..." - Hebrews 7:14

Jesus was from the tribe of Judah. The New Testament makes this clear. He is the King of Kings. He is the one who will rule the nations. The dying words of Jacob were not just a family blessing. They were a prophecy about Jesus. The promise was kept. Your new life has a King.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You have a King. You are not wandering through life without a leader. Jesus is your King. He is a good King. He is a kind King. He is a King who loves you. You can trust His leadership. Your new life is under His rule.

Faith Builder
What area of your new life is hard to surrender to the King? Write it down. Ask Jesus to help you trust His leadership in that area.

The Prayer
God, you are the King of Kings. Thank you for your plan that unfolds across thousands of years. Thank you that you are in control of history. Thank you that you are in control of my history. Help me to trust you with my future. Help me to trust you with my life. Amen.

Day 04: The Promise of a Star

The Promise (OT)
"I see him, but not now; I behold him, but not near. A star will come out of Jacob; a scepter will rise out of Israel." - Numbers 24:17 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

Balaam was a pagan prophet. He was hired by a king to curse Israel. But God would not let him. God turned his curses into blessings. God gave him a vision. Balaam saw a star. He saw a scepter. He saw a king. He said a star would come out of Jacob. This was a promise of your new life.

The Proof (NT)
"Where is the one who has been born king of the Jews? We saw his star when it rose and have come to worship him." - Matthew 2:2

When Jesus was born, wise men came from the east. They were star gazers. They saw a star in the sky. They knew the ancient prophecy. They knew a star would signal the birth of a king. They traveled hundreds of miles to find Him. The star led them to Jesus. The promise was kept. Your new life has a guiding star.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
The stars themselves were pointing to a king. The universe is not silent. It speaks. It points. If the stars can point to a king, maybe there is a God who wants to be found. And maybe He wants to be found by you. Your new life is guided by His light.

Faith Builder

Look up at the sky tonight. Count the stars. Remember that the same God who made those stars made a way for you to know Him.

The Prayer
God, the heavens declare your glory. Thank you for putting signs in the sky that point to Jesus. Thank you for the wise men who followed the star. Help me to follow the clues that lead to you. Help me to seek you with all my heart. Amen.

Day 05: The Promise of a Prophet

The Promise (OT)
"I will raise up for them a prophet like you from among their fellow Israelites, and I will put my words in his mouth. He will tell them everything I command him." - Deuteronomy 18:18 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

Moses was talking to the people. He said, "God will raise up a prophet like me." This was a massive claim. Moses was the greatest prophet in Jewish history. But he said someone else was coming. This new prophet would speak God's words. The people were supposed to listen to Him. This was a promise of your new life.

The Proof (NT)
"For Moses said, 'The Lord your God will raise up for you a prophet like me from among your own people; you must listen to everything he tells you.'" - Acts 3:22

Peter quotes this prophecy in the book of Acts. He applies it to Jesus. Jesus is the new Moses. Moses led people out of physical slavery in Egypt. Jesus leads people out of spiritual slavery to sin. Moses gave the law. Jesus gives grace. The promise was kept. Your new life has a liberator.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are not just following a teacher. You are following a liberator. A teacher can tell you what to do. A liberator can set you free. Jesus sets you free from your past. He sets you free from your guilt. He sets you free from your fear. Your new life is a free life.

Faith Builder
What are you still in slavery to today? Is it a bad habit? Is it a fear? Is it a lie you believe about yourself? Tell Jesus. He is the liberator.

The Prayer
God, thank you for sending Jesus. He is greater than Moses. He speaks your words. Help me to listen to Him. Help me to follow Him. Set me free from the things that hold me back. Amen.

Day 06: The Promise of a Branch

The Promise (OT)
"A shoot will come up from the stump of Jesse; from his roots a Branch will bear fruit." - Isaiah 11:1 (Written around 700 B.C.)

Jesse was the father of King David. David was a great king. But his family line looked like a dead stump. It looked finished. It looked like nothing would ever grow there again. But Isaiah said, "A shoot will come up from the stump of Jesse." He said a Branch would bear fruit. This was a promise of your new life.

The Proof (NT)
"And again, Isaiah says, 'The Root of Jesse will spring up, one who will arise to rule over the nations; in him the Gentiles will hope.'" - Romans 15:12

Jesus is that Branch. He came from the line of David. He came from the stump of Jesse. He is the King who rose from a dead family line. And Paul says something amazing in Romans. He says the Gentiles will hope in Him. This Branch is not just for one nation. He is for the whole world. The promise was kept. Your new life has new life.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
God specializes in bringing life out of broken things. Are you feeling like a dead stump? Are you feeling like something in your old life is finished? Maybe a dream died. Maybe a relationship ended. God can bring a green shoot. He can bring new life. Your new life is a resurrection life.

Faith Builder
What "dead stump" area do you need God to bring life to? Write it down. Ask Him for a green shoot.

The Prayer
God, you bring life out of dead things. Thank you for the Branch that grew from the stump of Jesse. Thank you for Jesus. I ask you to bring new life to the broken places in my heart. Bring new life to my dreams. Bring new life to my family. Amen.

Day 07: The Promise of a Miracle

The Promise (OT)
"Therefore the Lord himself will give you a sign: The virgin will conceive and give birth to a son, and will call him Immanuel." - Isaiah 7:14 (Written around 700 B.C.)

Isaiah was speaking to a king named Ahaz. Ahaz was a wicked king. He was worried about enemies. God told him to ask for a sign. Ahaz refused. So God said, "I will give you a sign anyway." And the sign was a virgin giving birth. The child would be called Immanuel. Immanuel means "God with us." This was a promise of your new life.

The Proof (NT)

"The virgin will conceive and give birth to a son, and they will call him Immanuel" (which means "God with us"). - Matthew 1:23

Matthew tells us that Jesus is the fulfillment of this prophecy. Mary was a virgin. She became pregnant by the power of the Holy Spirit. She gave birth to Jesus. He is God with us. The promise was kept. Your new life has God with you.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
We serve a God who does impossible things. Are you facing an impossible situation in your new life? A problem no doctor can fix? A relationship no counselor can fix? A financial situation no bank can fix? God can do the impossible. He is the God of the impossible. Your new life is a miraculous life.

Faith Builder
What is your "impossible" situation today? Name it. Then say out loud, "God can do the impossible."

The Prayer
God, you are the God of the impossible. Thank you for sending Jesus, born of a virgin. Thank you that you are with us. Help me to believe that you can do impossible things in my life. Help me to trust you with the impossible. Amen.

Day 08: The Promise of a Birthplace

The Promise (OT)
"But you, Bethlehem Ephrathah, though you are small among the clans of Judah, out of you will come for me one who will be ruler over Israel, whose origins are from of old, from ancient times." - Micah 5:2 (Written around 700 B.C.)

Micah was a prophet. He was looking at the towns of Judah. He said, "Bethlehem, you are small." Bethlehem was a small town. It was not a capital. It was not a major city. But Micah said the ruler of Israel would come from Bethlehem. This was a specific address. It was a promise of your new life.

The Proof (NT)
"So Joseph also went up from the town of Nazareth in Galilee to Judea, to Bethlehem the town of David, because he belonged to the house and line of David." - Luke 2:4

Joseph and Mary lived in Nazareth. They were far from Bethlehem. But the Roman emperor Caesar Augustus ordered a census. Every person had to go to their ancestral town to register. Joseph was from the line of David. David was from Bethlehem. So Joseph traveled to Bethlehem. And Mary went with him. She gave birth in Bethlehem. The promise was kept. Your new life has a specific plan.

Why It Matters For Your New Life

God pays attention to details. If He cared enough to arrange the exact birthplace of His son, He cares about the details of your new life. He cares about your address. He cares about your family. He cares about the small things. Your new life is a detailed life.

Faith Builder
What small detail of your new life do you need to trust God with today? Write it down. Give it to Him.

The Prayer
God, thank you for caring about details. Thank you for planning every step of your son's life. Thank you that you care about my life too. Help me to trust you with the small things. Help me to trust you with the big things. Amen.

Day 09: The Promise of a Child

The Promise (OT)
"For to us a child is born, to us a son is given, and the government will be on his shoulders. And he will be called Wonderful Counselor, Mighty God, Everlasting Father, Prince of Peace." - Isaiah 9:6 (Written around 700 B.C.)

These are big titles. Wonderful Counselor. Mighty God. Everlasting Father. Prince of Peace. These are not titles for a normal child. These are titles for God. Isaiah said the child would be God. This was a promise of your new life.

The Proof (NT)
"I and the Father are one." - John 10:30

Jesus made a claim that shocked everyone. He said, "I and the Father are one." He was saying He is God. He was saying He is the Mighty God. The religious leaders tried to kill Him for saying this. They knew what He meant. The promise was kept. Your new life has a Mighty God.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are not just following a good man. You are in a relationship with the Creator of the universe. He is mighty. He is eternal. He is your Father. He is your peace. That is a big God. And He loves you. Your new life is a relationship with God.

Faith Builder
Which title of Jesus do you need most today? Wonderful Counselor? Mighty God? Everlasting Father? Prince of Peace? Tell Him.

The Prayer
Jesus, you are Mighty God. Thank you for coming to earth. Thank you for stepping down from heaven. Thank you for being the Everlasting Father. Help me to know you more. Help me to love you more. Amen.

Day 10: The Promise of a Journey

The Promise (OT)
"When Israel was a child, I loved him, and out of Egypt I called my son." - Hosea 11:1 (Written around 750 B.C.)

Hosea wrote this about the nation of Israel. God called Israel out of Egypt in the book of Exodus. But Matthew saw a deeper meaning. He saw that this verse also pointed to Jesus. Jesus is the true Son of God. He also came out of Egypt. This was a promise of your new life.

The Proof (NT)
"So he got up, took the child and his mother during the night and left for Egypt, where he stayed until the death of Herod. And so was fulfilled what the Lord had said through the prophet: 'Out of Egypt I called my son.'" - Matthew 2:14-15

King Herod was jealous. He wanted to kill the baby Jesus. An angel appeared to Joseph in a dream. The angel said, "Get up. Take the child and his mother and escape to Egypt." Joseph obeyed. He took Mary and Jesus and fled to Egypt. The promise was kept. Your new life has a refuge.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
Jesus knows what it feels like to be displaced. He knows what it feels like to be afraid. He knows what it feels like to be a refugee. He understands your fears. He is not far away from your pain. Your new life has a Savior who understands.

Faith Builder
What are you afraid of today? Tell Jesus. He understands fear. He will be with you in it.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for understanding what it feels like to be afraid. Thank you for being with me when I am scared. Thank you for protecting me. Thank you for being my refuge. Amen.

Day 11: The Promise of Grief

The Promise (OT)
"This is what the LORD says: 'A voice is heard in Ramah, mourning and great weeping, Rachel weeping for her children and refusing to be comforted, because they are no more.'" - Jeremiah 31:15 (Written around 600 B.C.)

Jeremiah was writing about the exile of Israel. Rachel was the mother of Joseph and Benjamin. She was a symbol of all the mothers of Israel. The prophecy says she is weeping. This was a promise of your new life.

The Proof (NT)
"When Herod realized that he had been outwitted by the Magi, he was furious, and he gave orders to kill all the boys in Bethlehem and its vicinity who were two years old and under..." - Matthew 2:16

When the wise men did not return to King Herod, he was furious. He ordered that all the boys in Bethlehem who were two years old and under be killed. The mothers of Bethlehem wept. The promise was kept. Your new life has a God who weeps with you.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
The Bible does not ignore pain. It enters into it. God is with you in your grief. He sees your tears. He collects them in a bottle. You are not alone in your sorrow. Your new life has a God who is with you in pain.

Faith Builder
What is causing you grief today? Bring it to God. He is not afraid of your tears.

The Prayer
God, you see my tears. You know my pain. Thank you for not ignoring my suffering. Thank you for being with me in the darkness. Comfort me today. Comfort those who are grieving. Amen.

Day 12: The Promise of a Voice

The Promise (OT)
"A voice of one calling: 'In the wilderness prepare the way for the LORD; make straight in the desert a highway for our God.'" - Isaiah 40:3 (Written around 700 B.C.)

Isaiah wrote about a voice in the wilderness. This voice would cry out. It would tell people to prepare the way for the Lord. This was a promise of your new life.

The Proof (NT)
"In those days John the Baptist came, preaching in the wilderness of Judea and saying, 'Repent, for the kingdom of heaven has come near.'" - Matthew 3:1-3

John the Baptist was that voice. He lived in the wilderness. He preached a message of repentance. He told people Jesus was coming. The promise was kept. Your new life has a preparation.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
God is always working behind the scenes to prepare you for what He has next. He is preparing your heart right now. He is getting you ready for something good. Your new life is a prepared life.

Faith Builder
What do you think God is preparing you for right now? Ask Him to show you.

The Prayer
God, thank you for the voices that point to Jesus. Thank you for the people who prepared the way for me to know you. Prepare my heart for what you have for me. Help me to be ready. Amen.

Day 13: The Promise of Healing

The Promise (OT)
"The Spirit of the Sovereign LORD is on me, because the LORD has anointed me to proclaim good news to the poor. He has sent me to bind up the brokenhearted, to proclaim freedom for the captives and release from darkness for the prisoners..." - Isaiah 61:1 (Written around 700 B.C.)

Isaiah is speaking about the Messiah. He says the Spirit of the Lord is on Him. He says the Lord has anointed Him. He is anointed to heal. He is anointed to set free. This was a promise of your new life.

The Proof (NT)
"He went to Nazareth... and on the Sabbath day he went into the synagogue... He stood up to read... 'The Spirit of the Lord is on me...' Then he began to say to them, 'Today this scripture is fulfilled in your hearing.'" - Luke 4:16-21

Jesus read this exact passage. He said, "Today this scripture is fulfilled." The promise was kept. Your new life has a healer.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
This is your inheritance. Jesus came to heal your broken heart. He came to set you free. He came to give you good news. Are you broken? Are you captive? He is the healer. Your new life is a healed life.

Faith Builder
What part of your heart needs healing today? Ask Jesus to bind it up.

The Prayer
Jesus, you are the healer. Thank you for binding up my broken heart. Thank you for setting me free from the things that hold me captive. Thank you for the good news. Heal me today. Amen.

Day 14: The Promise of Light

The Promise (OT)
"The people walking in darkness have seen a great light; on those living in the land of deep darkness a light has dawned." - Isaiah 9:2 (Written around 700 B.C.)

Isaiah said the people walking in darkness would see a great light. This was a promise of your new life.

The Proof (NT)
"Leaving Nazareth, he went and lived in Capernaum... to fulfill what was said through the prophet Isaiah... the people living in darkness have seen a great light..." - Matthew 4:13-16

Jesus moved to Capernaum. He began His ministry there. He was the light in the darkness. The promise was kept. Your new life has a light.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
God meets you where you are. No place is too dark for His light to reach. No heart is too hard. No past is too broken. He brings light. Your new life is a lighted life.

Faith Builder
Where do you need light today? In your mind? In your family? In your future? Ask Jesus to shine.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for being the light in the darkness. Thank you for shining your light in the dark places. Shine your light into my heart today. Amen.

Day 15: The Promise of a Cornerstone

The Promise (OT)
"The stone the builders rejected has become the cornerstone; the LORD has done this, and it is marvelous in our eyes." - Psalm 118:22 (Written around 500 B.C.)

The builders looked at this stone and rejected it. But it became the cornerstone. This was a promise of your new life.

The Proof (NT)
"The stone the builders rejected has become the cornerstone; the Lord has done this, and it is marvelous in our eyes" - Matthew 21:42

Jesus quoted this Psalm. He applied it to Himself. He was the rejected stone. He became the cornerstone. The promise was kept. Your new life has a cornerstone.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
When others reject you, remember that God sees your worth. You are not a rejected stone. You are a cornerstone. You are part of God's building. You are important. Your new life is a valuable life.

Faith Builder

Have you been rejected by someone? Give that pain to God. Ask Him to show you your worth in Him.

The Prayer
God, thank you that you see my worth. Thank you that you do not reject me. Thank you that Jesus was rejected so that I could be accepted. Help me to find my worth in you. Amen.

Day 16: The Promise of Understanding

The Promise (OT)
"Those who hate me without reason outnumber the hairs of my head..." - Psalm 69:4 (Written around 1000 B.C.)

David wrote this Psalm. He was being chased by his enemies. They hated him for no reason. This was a promise of your new life.

The Proof (NT)
"They hated me without reason." - John 15:25

Jesus said the world hated Him without a reason. The promise was kept. Your new life has a Savior who understands rejection.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
When people mock your faith, remember that you are in good company. Jesus faced the same thing and overcame it. You will overcome too. Your new life is a victorious life.

Faith Builder
Is there someone who has hurt you because of your faith? Pray for them today. It is hard. But Jesus did it.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for enduring hatred for me. Thank you for loving me even when others hated you. Help me to love those who hate me. Help me to forgive those who hurt me. Amen.

Day 17: The Promise of Friendship

The Promise (OT)
"Even my close friend, someone I trusted, one who shared my bread, has turned against me." - Psalm 41:9 (Written around 1000 B.C.)

David wrote this Psalm. He was talking about a close friend who had betrayed him. This was a promise of your new life.

The Proof (NT)
"He who shared my bread has turned against me." - John 13:18

Jesus was betrayed by Judas. Judas shared bread with Jesus. Judas was His friend. But Judas betrayed Him. The promise was kept. Your new life has a Savior who understands betrayal.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
The greatest pain is not from enemies. It is from those we trust. If you have been betrayed by a friend, Jesus understands. He knows that pain. He will heal it. Your new life has a healer for broken friendships.

Faith Builder
Think of a time you were hurt by a friend. Give that memory to Jesus. Ask Him to heal the wound.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for understanding the pain of betrayal. Thank you for being a friend who never betrays. Heal my heart from the wounds of broken friendships. Help me to trust again. Amen.

Day 18: The Promise of Value

The Promise (OT)
"So they paid me thirty pieces of silver..." - Zechariah 11:12 (Written around 500 B.C.)

Zechariah was a prophet. He acted out a prophecy. He asked the people for his pay. They paid him thirty pieces of silver. This was a promise of your new life.

The Proof (NT)
"So they counted out for him thirty pieces of silver." - Matthew 26:15

Judas went to the chief priests. He asked them how much they would pay him to betray Jesus. They counted out thirty pieces of silver. The promise was kept. Your new life has value.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
Jesus allowed Himself to be valued at the price of a slave. Not because He was worth that much. But because He valued YOU that much. You are worth everything to Him. Your new life is a valuable life.

Faith Builder
Do you ever feel worthless? Remember that Jesus thought you were worth dying for. Write down this truth: "I am worth everything to Jesus."

The Prayer

Jesus, thank you for valuing me enough to humble yourself. Thank you for allowing yourself to be sold for thirty pieces of silver. Thank you for loving me that much. Help me to see my worth in you. Amen.

Day 19: The Promise of Silence

The Promise (OT)
"He was oppressed and afflicted, yet he did not open his mouth..." - Isaiah 53:7 (Written around 700 B.C.)

Isaiah described the suffering servant. He said the servant would be silent. This was a promise of your new life.

The Proof (NT)
"But Jesus made no reply, not even to a single charge..." - Matthew 27:14

Jesus was brought before Pilate. The chief priests and elders accused him. They made false charges. They lied about him. Pilate asked Jesus, "Don't you hear what they are saying?" Jesus said nothing. The promise was kept. Your new life has a Savior who was silent for you.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
Sometimes the most powerful thing you can do is be silent. Trusting God in the face of false accusations is a sign of strength. You do not have to fight every battle. God will fight for you. Your new life is a defended life.

Faith Builder
Is there a situation where you need to be silent and trust God? Write it down. Give it to Him.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for being silent so that I could speak to God. Thank you for enduring false accusations. Help me to trust you when I am accused. Help me to be silent when I need to be. Amen.

Day 20: The Promise of the Shepherd

The Promise (OT)
"Strike the shepherd, and the sheep will be scattered..." - Zechariah 13:7 (Written around 500 B.C.)

Zechariah said the sword will strike the shepherd. The shepherd will be smitten. And then the sheep will be scattered. This was a promise of your new life.

The Proof (NT)

"I will strike the shepherd, and the sheep of the flock will be scattered." - Matthew 26:31

Jesus quoted this prophecy. He told His disciples they would all fall away. Jesus was arrested. The disciples ran away. The promise was kept. Your new life has a Shepherd who comes after you.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
Even when you fail or run away, Jesus does not abandon you. He is the Good Shepherd who goes after the scattered sheep. He comes after you. He finds you. He brings you back. Your new life is a pursued life.

Faith Builder
Have you ever run away from God? Have you ever failed Him? He is still coming after you. Write down a prayer of return.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for never giving up on me. Thank you for coming after me when I run away. Thank you for being the Good Shepherd. Help me to stop running. Help me to stay close to you. Amen.

Day 21: The Promise of Substitution

The Promise (OT)
"He was numbered with the transgressors..." - Isaiah 53:12 (Written around 700 B.C.)

Isaiah said the Messiah would be numbered with the transgressors. Transgressors are criminals. The Messiah would be crucified with criminals. This was a promise of your new life.

The Proof (NT)
"Two other men, both criminals, were also led out with him to be executed..." - Luke 23:32-33

Jesus was crucified between two criminals. He was treated like a bad guy. The promise was kept. Your new life has a substitute.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
The innocent was treated like the guilty so the guilty could be set free. Jesus took your place. He was numbered with the criminals so you could be numbered with the saints. Your new life is a substituted life.

Faith Builder
Have you ever felt like a criminal? Have you ever felt like you did not deserve God's love? That is the point. None of us do. But He loves us anyway.

The Prayer

Jesus, thank you for being numbered with the criminals so I could be numbered with the saints. Thank you for forgiving me. Thank you for taking my place. Help me to forgive others. Amen.

Day 22: The Promise of Wounds

The Promise (OT)
"They pierce my hands and my feet." - Psalm 22:16 (Written around 1000 B.C.)

David wrote this Psalm. He described a person being attacked. He said they pierce his hands and his feet. This was a promise of your new life.

The Proof (NT)
"Unless I see the nail marks in his hands..." - John 20:25

Thomas saw the nail marks in Jesus' hands. The promise was kept. Your new life has a Savior with scars.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
The scars of Jesus are proof of His love for you. He bears those marks for eternity. He is not ashamed of them. He is not ashamed of you. Your new life is a scarred life

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Day 22: The Promise of Wounds (Continued)

Faith Builder
Do you have doubts? That is okay. Thomas did too. Bring your doubts to Jesus. He will show you His hands.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for the scars you bear for me. Thank you for the nail marks in your hands. Thank you for loving me that much. Help me to never forget your sacrifice. Amen.

Day 23: The Promise of Mocking

The Promise (OT)
"All who see me mock me; they hurl insults, shaking their heads..." - Psalm 22:7-8 (Written around 1000 B.C.)

David is describing the mockers. They mock him. They hurl insults. They shake their heads. This was a promise of your new life.

The Proof (NT)
"Those who passed by hurled insults at him, shaking their heads..." - Matthew 27:39

The people mocked Jesus. The promise was kept. Your new life has a Savior who understands mockery.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
When people mock your faith, remember that you are in good company. Jesus faced the same thing and overcame it. You will overcome too. Your new life is a victorious life.

Faith Builder
Have you been mocked for your faith? Write down a prayer asking God to give you strength.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for enduring mockery for me. Thank you for not coming down from the cross. Help me to stand strong when my faith is mocked. Help me to forgive those who mock me. Amen.

Day 24: The Promise of Thirst

The Promise (OT)
"They put gall in my food and gave me vinegar for my thirst." - Psalm 69:21 (Written around 1000 B.C.)

David wrote this Psalm. He is describing his suffering. He says, "They put gall in my food and gave me vinegar for my thirst." Gall is a bitter substance. Vinegar is sour wine. This was a promise of your new life.

The Proof (NT)
"There they offered Jesus wine to drink, mixed with gall; but after tasting it, he refused to drink it. Later, knowing that everything had now been finished, and so that Scripture would be fulfilled, Jesus said, 'I am thirsty.' A jar of wine vinegar was there, so they soaked a sponge in it, put the sponge on a stalk of the hyssop plant, and lifted it to Jesus' lips." - Matthew 27:34; John 19:28-29

The soldiers offered Jesus gall and vinegar. The promise was kept. Your new life has a Savior who suffered for you.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
Even in suffering, Jesus fulfilled the smallest details of prophecy. He is a God of precision and love. He cares about the details. Your new life is a detailed life.

Faith Builder
Do you feel like you are in a season of suffering? Remember that God is still in control. He has not forgotten you.

The Prayer
God, I trust you even in the small painful details of my life. Thank you for fulfilling every detail of the prophecy. Thank you for your precision. Help me to trust you with the details. Amen.

Day 25: The Promise of Clothing

The Promise (OT)
"They divide my clothes among them and cast lots for my garment." - Psalm 22:18 (Written around 1000 B.C.)

David is describing the scene at the crucifixion. He says, "They divide my clothes among them and cast lots for my garment." This was a promise of your new life.

The Proof (NT)
"When the soldiers crucified Jesus, they took his clothes, dividing them into four shares, one for each of them, with the undergarment remaining. This garment was seamless, woven in one piece from top to bottom. 'Let's not tear it,' they said to one another. 'Let's decide by lot who will get it.' This happened that the scripture might be fulfilled..." - John 19:23-24

The soldiers gambled for the garment of Jesus. The promise was kept. Your new life has a Savior who gave everything.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
Nothing that happens to you is outside of God's plan. Even the smallest details of your life are in His hands. He is in control. Your new life is a controlled life.

Faith Builder
What random thing happened to you this week? Can you see God's hand in it? Ask Him to show you.

The Prayer
Thank you, God, for being in control of every detail. Even the random things in my life are under your care. Help me to trust you. Help me to rest in your sovereignty. Amen.

Day 26: The Promise of Separation

The Promise (OT)
"My God, my God, why have you forsaken me? Why are you so far from saving me, so far from my cries of anguish?" - Psalm 22:1 (Written around 1000 B.C.)

David wrote this Psalm. He felt abandoned by God. He felt forsaken. He cried out, "My God, my God, why have you forsaken me?" This was a promise of your new life.

The Proof (NT)

"About three in the afternoon Jesus cried out in a loud voice, 'Eli, Eli, lema sabachthani?' (which means 'My God, my God, why have you forsaken me?')." - Matthew 27:46

Jesus quoted this Psalm on the cross. The promise was kept. Your new life has a Savior who was forsaken for you.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
Because Jesus experienced separation from God on the cross, you will never have to. You have permanent access to the Father. You will never be forsaken. Your new life is an accepted life.

Faith Builder
Do you ever feel forsaken? Do you ever feel alone? Remember that Jesus felt that too. He did it so you would not have to.

The Prayer
Thank you, Jesus, that I will never be forsaken. Thank you for experiencing separation so that I could experience acceptance. Thank you for the access I have to the Father. Amen.

Day 27: The Promise of Burial

The Promise (OT)
"He was assigned a grave with the wicked, and with the rich in his death, though he had done no violence, nor was any deceit in his mouth." - Isaiah 53:9 (Written around 700 B.C.)

Isaiah says the Messiah would be assigned a grave with the wicked. This meant He would die among criminals. But Isaiah also says He would be with the rich in His death. This was a promise of your new life.

The Proof (NT)
"As evening approached, there came a rich man from Arimathea, named Joseph, who had himself become a disciple of Jesus. Going to Pilate, he asked for Jesus' body, and Pilate ordered that it be given to him. Joseph took the body, wrapped it in a clean linen cloth, and placed it in his own new tomb that he had cut out of the rock." - Matthew 27:57-60

Joseph of Arimathea buried Jesus in his own new tomb. The promise was kept. Your new life has a Savior who was buried for you.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
Even in death, God honored His Son. He will honor you too. He will take care of your final resting place. He will take care of your legacy. Your new life is an honored life.

Faith Builder
What legacy do you want to leave? Write down one thing you want to be remembered for.

The Prayer

God, I trust you to honor me in my life and in my death. Thank you for the hope of the resurrection. Thank you for the empty tomb. Help me to live with eternity in mind. Amen.

Day 28: The Promise of Life

The Promise (OT)
"Therefore my heart is glad and my tongue rejoices; my body also will rest secure, because you will not abandon me to the realm of the dead, nor will you let your faithful one see decay." - Psalm 16:9-10 (Written around 1000 B.C.)

David wrote this Psalm. He said his body would rest secure. He said God would not abandon him to the realm of the dead. He said God would not let his faithful one see decay. This was a promise of your new life.

The Proof (NT)
"Seeing what was to come, he spoke of the resurrection of the Messiah, that he was not abandoned to the realm of the dead, nor did his body see decay. God has raised this Jesus to life, and we are all witnesses of it." - Acts 2:31-32

God raised Jesus to life. The promise was kept. Your new life has a resurrection.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
Death is not the end of the story. The grave is not the final word. Jesus is alive. And because He is alive, you will live forever. Your new life is an eternal life.

Faith Builder
Do you believe in the resurrection? Say it out loud: "Jesus is alive. And because He lives, I will live."

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for rising from the dead. Thank you for defeating death. Thank you that the grave is empty. Because you live, I will live forever. Help me to live in the power of your resurrection. Amen.

Day 29: The Promise of Victory

The Promise (OT)
"When you ascended on high, you took many captives; you received gifts from people, even from the rebellious—that you, LORD God, might dwell there." - Psalm 68:18 (Written around 1000 B.C.)

David wrote this Psalm. He is describing a victorious king. The king ascends on high. He takes captives. He receives gifts. This was a promise of your new life.

The Proof (NT)
"This is why it says: 'When he ascended on high, he took many captives and gave gifts to his people.'" - Ephesians 4:8

Paul quotes this Psalm. He applies it to Jesus. Jesus ascended on high. He took many captives. He gave gifts to His people. The promise was kept. Your new life has a victory.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
Jesus has taken back the keys of death and hell. You have access to His victory and His gifts. You are on the winning team. Your new life is a victorious life.

Faith Builder
What gift has Jesus given you? A talent? A friendship? A church family? Thank Him for it.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for sharing your victory with me. Thank you for the gifts you give me. Thank you for ascending on high. Help me to walk in your victory. Help me to use your gifts for your glory. Amen.

Day 30: The Promise of a Kingdom

The Promise (OT)
"In my vision at night I looked, and there before me was one like a son of man, coming with the clouds of heaven. He approached the Ancient of Days and was led into his presence. He was given authority, glory and sovereign power; all nations and peoples of every language worshiped him. His dominion is an everlasting dominion that will not pass away, and his kingdom is one that will never be destroyed." - Daniel 7:13-14 (Written around 600 B.C.)

Daniel saw a vision. He saw one like a son of man. He came with the clouds of heaven. He approached the Ancient of Days. He was given authority. He was given glory. He was given sovereign power. All nations worshiped him. His dominion is everlasting. This was a promise of your new life.

The Proof (NT)
"The seventh angel sounded his trumpet, and there were loud voices in heaven, which said: 'The kingdom of the world has become the kingdom of our Lord and of his Messiah, and he will reign for ever and ever.'" - Revelation 11:15

This is the final fulfillment. The kingdom of the world becomes the kingdom of our Lord. Jesus reigns forever. His kingdom will never end. The promise was kept. Your new life has a forever kingdom.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
Your eternal future is secure in the Kingdom of God. The best is yet to come. You are part of a forever kingdom. Your new life is an eternal life.

Faith Builder
What is one thing you learned about your new life over the last 30 days that you will never forget? Write it down.

The Prayer
Jesus, I give my life to you. Take my life and use it for your kingdom. Thank you for the hope of eternity. Thank you for the promise of a forever kingdom. Come, Lord Jesus. Amen.

END MATTER

The 30-Day Promise Challenge
You have journeyed through 30 ancient promises. You have seen the predictions. You have seen the fulfillment. Now what? I challenge you to read the Gospel of John. It is 21 chapters. It tells the story of Jesus from the perspective of an eyewitness. As you read, look for the promises. Look for the fulfillment. Look for your new life.

A Note on Faith
Evidence is important. It satisfies the mind. But evidence does not save you. The evidence points to a person. The evidence points to Jesus. You can believe the facts and still be far from God. The invitation is for your heart. Jesus said, "Here I am! I stand at the door and knock. If anyone hears my voice and opens the door, I will come in." The evidence is on the table. The door is open. It is your choice.

About the Author
[Author Name] loves helping new believers build a strong foundation. He believes that faith is not a blind leap. It is a confident step based on evidence. He lives with his family and enjoys hiking and reading.

Coming Next: The Divine Blueprint for Kids
If you have children, the next series is for them. The Divine Blueprint for Kids takes the same 30 truths and turns them into a fun, interactive adventure. It includes family activities, coloring pages, and simple prayers.

Final Call to Action
Scan the QR code below to get the next book in the series. Visit our website to download a free reading plan. Join our community of believers. The journey is not over. The adventure is just beginning.

Cover Design Concept (The New Believer Edition)

A soft, warm cream or light parchment background. A large, ancient scroll sits in the center. The scroll is open, and a bright light shines from it. The title THE ANCIENT PROMISE is in a strong, trustworthy, bold serif font. The subtitle is in a gentle, welcoming sans-serif. The overall feel is warm, inviting, and hopeful.